

April

8

1271

### The fallen fortress

Considered impossible to capture, the Krak des Chevaliers fortress in Syria, built by European crusaders, was seized by Sultan Baibars, an important Islamic ruler.



### Also on this day

**1904** After nearly 1,000 years of recurring conflict, Britain and France signed the Entente Cordiale, finally making peace.

**1974** Black American baseball star Hank Aaron hit his 715th home run to beat Babe Ruth's record, in front of more than 53,000 spectators.

**1983** Live on television, US magician David Copperfield seemingly made the Statue of Liberty vanish for a few moments, shocking viewers with his astonishing trick.

### Born this day

**1941** Vivienne Westwood, self-taught British fashion designer. She became an icon of British fashion with her bold designs.



1942

### Unlikely soldier

A group of Polish soldiers adopted a brown bear cub in Iran and gave him the rank of Private. The bear became the most famous member of their regiment and was later promoted to Corporal.

2008

### Turbine towers

The three power-generating wind turbines between the twin towers of the World Trade Centre in Bahrain were turned on together for the first time. No other skyscrapers had been designed with built-in wind turbines before.

